



BEN BREWER Bloomberg

SOYBEANS are harvested in Rochester, Minn. The crop is one of the hardest hit by the China trade dispute.

TRUMP PROMISES CASH AID TO FARMERS

\$12-billion package would help those hurt by the president’s trade war with China.

By SEUNG MIN KIM, JOSH FUNK AND DIDI TANG

WASHINGTON — President Trump announced a \$12-billion farm aid package Monday — a boost to farmers who have struggled to sell their crops while getting hit by rising costs after the president raised tariffs on China as part of a broader trade war.

He unveiled the plan Monday afternoon at a White House roundtable with Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent, Agriculture Secretary Brooke Rollins, lawmakers and farmers who raise cattle and grow corn, cotton, sorghum, soybeans, rice, wheat and potatoes.

“\$12 billion is a lot of money,” Trump said, adding that the additional aid will help provide certainty for farmers. The money is coming from tariff revenue, he said.

Rollins said that \$11 billion is being announced on Monday, and that an additional \$1 billion is being held back for specialty crops as the administration works to better understand the circumstances for those farmers. The aid will move by the end of February, Rollins said.

“We looked at how they were hurt, to what extent they were hurt,” Trump said in explaining how the administration came up with the size of the package. “We figured out a very exact number, and it was about \$12 billion.”

Farmers have backed Trump politically, but his aggressive trade policies and frequently changing tariff rates have come under increasing scrutiny because of the impact on the agricultural sector and because of broader consumer worries.

The aid is the administration’s latest effort to defend Trump’s economic stewardship and answer voter angst about rising costs — even as the president has dismissed concerns about affordability as a Democratic “hoax.”

More than \$11 billion is set [See **Farmers**, A6]

L.A. man’s crusade to take back usurped parking spots

Residents are illegally blocking off coveted spaces. TikTok’s ‘Cone King’ is pushing back.

By KAREN GARCIA

Joey Morales’ Ford SUV stopped along a quiet residential street in South L.A., its headlights shining on what would be a perfect parking spot if not for the three orange cones blocking it.

Cones in this part of town carry weight — they’re used not just by public works and construction crews but by locals as de facto gatekeepers blocking vehicles from

crossing. With a friend filming him for his growing TikTok following as the “Cone King,” Morales, 31, exited his vehicle in a yellow reflective vest, grabbed the cones and tossed them into his SUV.

His next step would be giving the cones away to construction crews, or if labeled as L.A. property, returning them to the city.

In Los Angeles, the battle for public parking spaces has been likened to a blood sport. Be it cones, trash cans, fake “No Parking” signs or other items, Angelenos have for decades made the act of parking on a public street a virtual survival of the fittest and best prepared in a city of 3.8 million.

But saving a parking spot

by obstructing the street, without a valid permit, is against the city’s municipal code.

In the last fiscal year, StreetsLA, a division of the city’s Public Works Department, responded to more than 4,000 requests to remove obstructions in public rights-of-way, which include street parking spaces, said StreetsLA spokesperson Dan Halden.

Those who violate the law are subject to administrative fines beginning at \$50, but that’s about it, according to the city. Los Angeles police do not respond to parking disputes over things such as cones unless there’s a “fight breaking out or some

[See **Parking**, A6]



CHRISTINA HOUSE Los Angeles Times

IT WILL be business as usual for the unmasked restaurant reviewer.

Voices BILL ADDISON RESTAURANT CRITIC

After two decades, I’m dropping my anonymity

Going faceless has a shelf life, and I’ve hit mine

I raced into adulthood intent on fame. I was a vocal performance major at Berklee College of Music in Boston, and halfway through my sophomore year I transferred to nearby Emerson College to earn a BFA in acting. My modest goals: Make it as a pop star, and then break into film.

Instead, in the great tradition of creative types with little idea how to make their outsized dreams a reality, I turned to work in restaurants. A decade whizzed by. Staring down 30 with little progress toward superstardom, I pivoted my ambitions to a different seemingly impossible career path — one with tenets that demanded the exact opposite of celebrity. A tribe for which inconspicuousness was the ultimate accomplishment.

I became a restaurant critic.

Anonymity remains braided into any conversation about food criticism, a lingering mystique in the collective consciousness that conjures wigs and spy-craft and debate about how long one can pull off the masquerade. It was the original North Star precept for reviewers aiming to have everyman dining experiences, part of a job conceived in the 1960s when tiny cameras were fantastical Bond gadgets.

For nearly a quarter-century, through critic positions at six publications, I’ve known my photo finds its way onto collages of food writer pics that chefs hang on their kitchen walls, but thankfully no one was ever vindictive enough to splatter my face across the internet.

Facelessness has a shelf life in this niche line of work, and I’ve reached mine.

[See **Addison**, A7]

Paramount makes a hostile bid for Warner

Proposed takeover by Netflix rival offers \$30 per share directly to the stockholders.

By MEG JAMES

Paramount is refusing to accept defeat in the Warner Bros. Discovery auction, launching a \$78-billion hostile takeover of its rival on Monday after being spurned last week in the bidding.

The move comes four days after Warner’s board unanimously selected Netflix as the winner.

Paramount has beefed up its offer with backing from Middle Eastern sovereign wealth funds, including Saudi Arabia, a Chinese firm and President Trump’s son-in-law Jared Kushner’s investment firm Affinity Partners, according to a Monday regulatory filing.

The presence of a member of the president’s family in a proposed corporate takeover, which includes news channel CNN and the historic Warner Bros. properties, immediately complicates an already fraught regulatory picture.

Last week, Netflix had offered \$72 billion — or \$27.75 a share — for a big chunk of the company: Warner Bros.

film and television studios, which hold the rights to Batman, Bugs Bunny and Harry Potter, the expansive lot in Burbank and HBO and HBO Max. Additionally, Netflix would take on more than \$10 billion in Warner Bros. debt for a total deal value of \$82.7 billion.

Paramount, backed by billionaire Larry Ellison’s family, had entered the final week of the auction with a \$25 a share, all-cash offer for all of Warner Bros. Discovery, according to people involved in the auction who were not authorized to comment. In the final hours, Paramount upped its offer to \$30 per share — but still came away empty-handed.

Paramount confirmed Monday that it submitted its \$30-per-share offer just a few hours before Netflix was announced as the winner.

“We never heard back,” Paramount Chairman and Chief Executive David Ellison told CNBC on Monday morning. “We’re really here to finish what we started.”

Despite the decision by Netflix and Warner Bros. Discovery to pursue a deal, Paramount is directly appealing to shareholders to vote on their offer in what is commonly known as a hostile takeover.

[See **Paramount**, A11]

Court signals boost to executive power

Conservative justices lean toward letting Trump fire officials at independent agencies.

By DAVID G. SAVAGE

WASHINGTON — The Supreme Court’s conservatives sounded ready on Monday to overrule Congress and give President Trump more power to fire officials at independent agencies and commissions.

The justices heard arguments on whether Trump could fire Rebecca Slaughter, one of two Democratic appointees on the five-member Federal Trade Commission.

The case poses a clash between Congress’ power to structure the government

versus the president’s “executive power.”

A ruling for Trump portends a historic shift in the federal government — away from bipartisan experts and toward more partisan control by the president.

Trump’s solicitor general, D. John Sauer, said the court should overturn a 1935 decision that upheld independent agencies. The decision “was grievously wrong when decided. It must be overruled,” he told the court.

The court’s three liberals strongly argued against what they called a “radical change” in American government.

If the president is free to fire the leaders of independent agencies, they said, the long-standing civil service laws could be struck down as well.

[See **Court**, A6]

TLC for fire-ravaged Scout campground

By NOAH HAGGERTY

Elliot Copen, 17, was worried the Scouting America camp he had visited dozens of times in an undeveloped canyon of the Santa Monica Mountains would feel empty.

The Palisades fire roared down the canyon 11 months ago, destroying the historic lodge and its Hogwarts-like interior (albeit without the “flying balls,” he noted), a smattering of cabins and the trading post where Scouts would buy candies and memorabilia. Weeks later,

heavy rains sent mud and debris careening into the canyon, burying sections of the camp in feet of dirt.

Elliot, an Eagle Scout with Troop 67 in Santa Monica and a leader in the Scouts’ honor society Order of the Arrow, had seen the videos online of what the disaster had done to the camp where he had made so many memories. “It was just weird,” he said. “It felt wrong.”

On Saturday, he was one of about four dozen Scouts, parents and regional Scouting leaders who headed to

[See **Scouts**, A7]



GENARO MOLINA Los Angeles Times

COLIN CORZO clears mud and debris at Camp Josepho, which was damaged by the Palisades fire.

Trump’s pick for prosecutor quits

Federal judges ruled Alina Habba had been illegally installed as acting U.S. attorney in New Jersey. **NATION**, A4

A fight for soul of Belmont Shore

Residents and businesses call for Long Beach to crack down on drunkenness, crime and noise. **CALIFORNIA**, B1

‘Battle’ garners nine Globe nods

Star Leonardo DiCaprio is among the nominees as film awards season begins to take shape. **ENTERTAINMENT**, E1

Weather
Sunshine.
L.A. Basin: 82/53. **B6**

